

Mock Exam

Solutions

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Honour pledge: *I promise that I neither gave nor received any unauthorized assistance on this exam, and that the work herein is entirely my own.*

Name

Student ID

Signature

Date

This exam consists of tasks that test your knowledge and skills in various sub-fields of English linguistics based on the Proseminar *Introduction to Linguistics* by Dr. Quirin Würschinger. Most linguistic examples used in this exam are either taken or adapted from an authentic English text provided at the beginning of the exam.

Duration 60 minutes

Points 60 points

Score

Grade

Corpus text

My experiment in phonelessness was a failure. It also changed my life

Two months after Rhik Samadder ended his phone detox, he realises some of its lessons actually stuck with him In the final update in Rhik's journey to break his phone addiction, he manages a breakthrough. And a big one.

"Do you want to be my girlfriend?" I ask Almond one day.

She is leafing through bags of Thai basil, like record store vinyl. "I already am. That's what this is," she says patiently, giving my hand a squeeze. Oh, right, I say. OK. Yes, good.

Two months after my last diary entry, something weird has occurred. Having written the experiment off as a waste of time, it seems to be bearing perverse fruit. I'm currently on my phone for 90 minutes a day. Five of those are spent on Instagram. I no longer feel addicted. My diminished online life is partly due to no longer having to scan the savannah for a mate. But that can't be the whole story.

All the experts I spoke to gave reassuringly similar advice. Strangely, the most impactful tech conversation was in a wifi-less cafe, with a Buddhist. Sthiramanas is a meditation teacher from the London Buddhist Centre, where he runs Upgrade Your Mind, a six-week course on mindful screen use.

"It's a fundamental human weakness to look outside for satisfaction," he says. Sthiramanas doesn't just mean endless scrolling. Running to a silent retreat – or a digital detox cabin in the woods – is also an escape from day-to-day life. Their lessons often don't survive the journey home. "If we want our lives to be happier and more creative, we have to experience them as they are, and change things from there.

"What's the desire underneath the desire to check your phone?" he continued. "If you're addicted to dating apps, is it the desire to feel attractive? If you're a news junkie, do you want to feel in control? Or in contact with something bigger than yourself? If you're constantly texting friends, do you just want to be loved?"

Ouch. When did these Buddhists choose violence?

Since that chat, I see friendship as a mostly offline activity. Something we do with our bodies. My gang are good for this – arranging day trips to the seaside, dancing, cooking for each other. Laughing in the same space is nourishing. Sounds Waltons-esque, but it's better than Meta. I do still often text friends through the day, but when not, I enjoy missing them. Maybe I've gone weird.

[...]

Rhik Samadder, The Guardian, 5 Feb 2024

(<https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle/2024/feb/05/phone-screentime-detox-reflection>)

1 Fundamentals

1.1 [4] Explain the difference between paradigmatic and syntagmatic relations in language and use an example for illustration.

See course materials.

2 Phonetics and phonology

2.1 [4] Describe the following phonemes according to their distinctive articulatory features.

2.1.1 /s/ as in *savannah* [→ corpus text]

consonant, fricative, alveolar, voiceless

2.1.2 /ɪ/ as in *written* [→ corpus text]

vowel, front, half-closed, short, spread

2.1.3 /r/ as in *record* [→ corpus text]

consonant, approximant, post-alveolar

2.1.4 /æ/ as in *satisfaction* [→ corpus text]

vowel, front, open, short, spread

2.2 [3] Give a phonemic (IPA) transcription of the following words.

Please indicate whether your transcription is based on

- ☐ Received Pronunciation (RP)
- ☐ or General American (GA).

2.2.1 *cooking* [→ corpus text]

Variety	IPA
RP	/ˈkʊkɪŋ/
GA	/ˈkʊkɪŋ/

2.2.2 *fundamental* [→ corpus text]

Variety	IPA
RP	/ˌfʌndəˈmentəl/
GA	/ˌfʌndəˈmentəl/

2.2.3 *attractive* [→ corpus text]

Variety	IPA
RP	/əˈtræktɪv/
GA	/əˈtræktɪv/

2.3 [4] Minimal pair analysis.

Explain what minimal pair analysis is and what it can be used for. Then, decide whether the following pairs are minimal pairs and justify your decisions.

1. *eyes, ice*
2. *two, too*
3. *heart, chart*

1. *eyes, ice*

- /aɪz/ vs /aɪs/: difference in 1 phoneme
- difference in meaning
- → minimal pair

2. *two, too*

- /tu:/ vs /tu:/: no difference in phonemes → no minimal pair

3. *heart, chart*

- RP: /hɑ:t/ vs /tʃɑ:t/; GA: /hɑ:rt/ vs /tʃɑ:rt/: difference in 1 phoneme
- difference in meaning
- → minimal pair

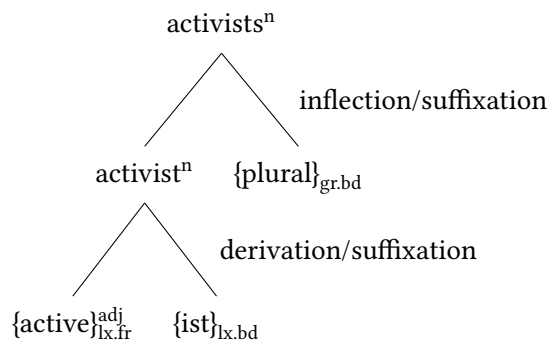
3 Morphology and word-formation

3.1 [3] What is a word? Explain the difference between *lexemes*, *word-forms*, and *tokens* and give examples.

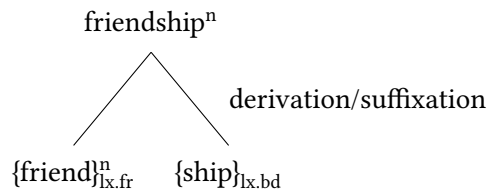
See course materials.

3.2 [8] Provide a full morphological analysis (morpheme types and morphological processes in “tree format”) for each of the following words.

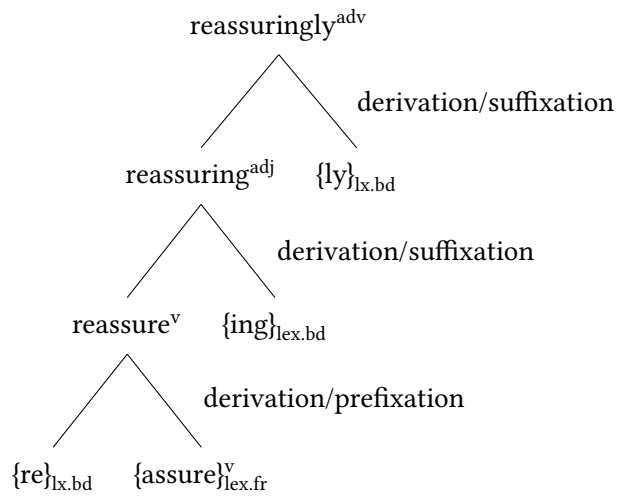
3.2.1 *activists*



3.2.2 *friendship* [→ corpus text]



3.2.3 *reassuringly* [→ corpus text]

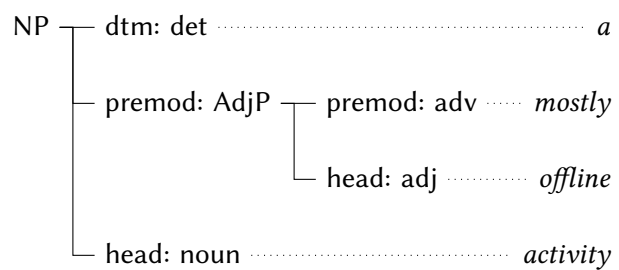


4 Syntax

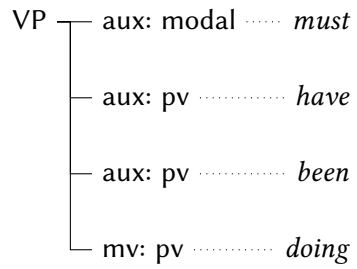
4.1 [4] Analyse the phrase structure of the underlined phrases in the following sentences.

Analyse only the underlined phrases; analysing the full sentence is not required.

4.1.1 *I see friendship as a mostly offline activity.* [→ corpus text]

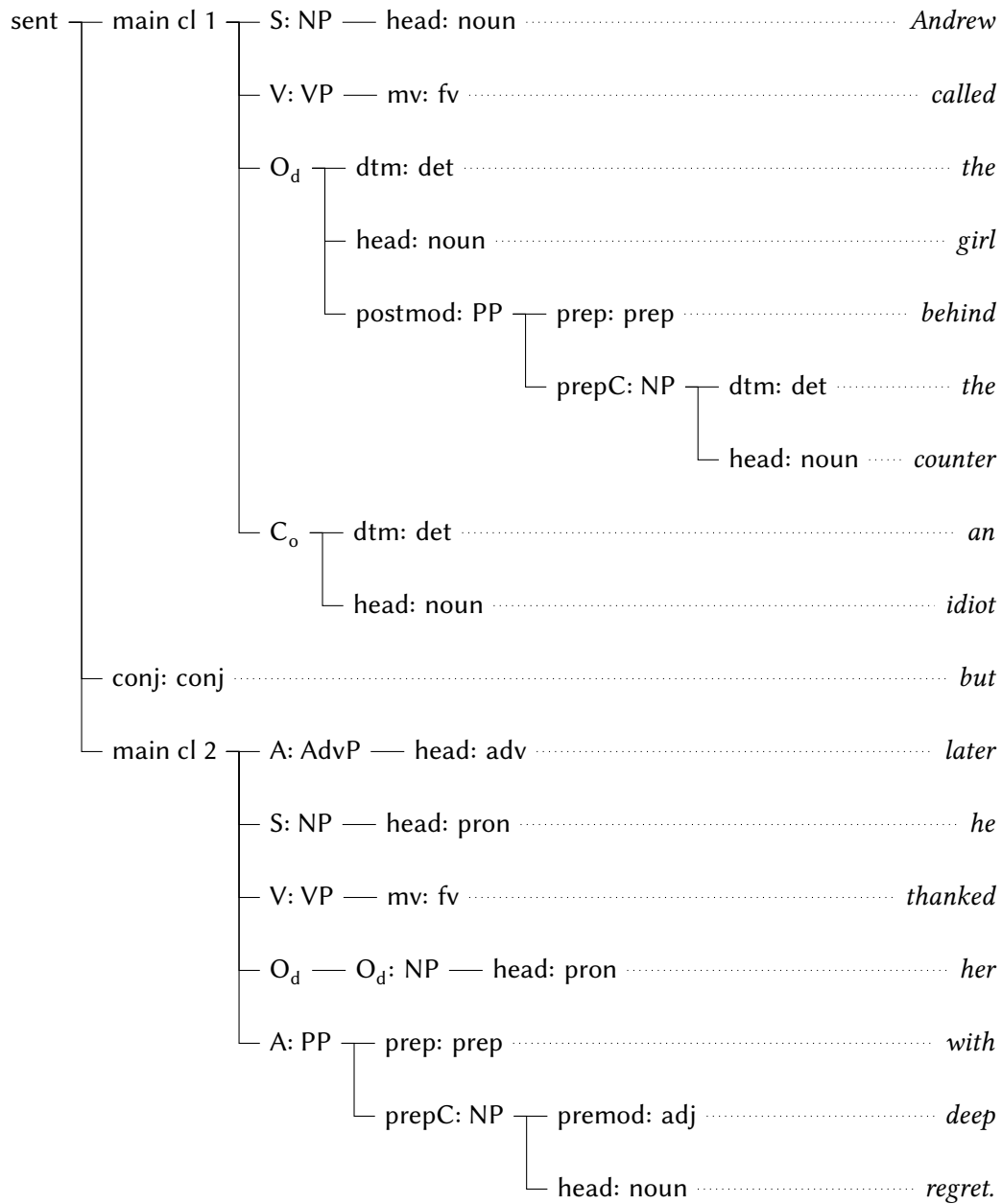


4.1.2 *He must have been doing something important.*



4.2 [10] **Perform a full syntactic analysis of the following sentence.**

Andrew called the girl behind the counter an idiot but later he thanked her with deep regret.



5 Semantics

5.1 [3] Explain the difference between the onomasiological and semasiological perspective on words and their meanings.

See course materials.

5.2 [4] Name the semantic relation that holds between the following lexemes.

5.2.1 *teacher* — *student*

antonyms/converse

5.2.2 *bread* — *butter*

collocation

5.2.3 *fast* — *slow*

antonyms/polar

5.2.4 *page* — *book*

- holonym: *book*
- meronym: *page*

6 Pragmatics

6.1 [4] Describe the Cooperative Principle as formulated by Grice. Describe its basic assumption and goal, enumerate and briefly describe the four conversational maxims that underpin this principle, and provide an example illustrating the violation of at least one of these maxims.

See course materials.

7 Sociolinguistics

- 7.1 [4] Linguistic varieties can be subdivided into *diatopic*, *diastratal*, and *diaphasic* variation. Describe what these terms mean, explain the two fundamental dimensions of variation underlying this distinction, and give one example each for all three types of varieties.

See course materials.

8 History of English

- 8.1 [5] How does Middle English differ from Old English? Describe the linguistic characteristics of Middle English and outline which historical developments have contributed to these changes.

See course materials.